Edition	Date published	Examples of new features
1	June 1997	
2	June 1998	
3	December 1999	Regular expressions Improved string handling Exception handling
4	*Abandoned*	
5	December 2009	Strict mode Native JSON support New object methods Property descriptors
6	*In progress*	Rest and spread parameters Template strings Default parameters Destructuring assignment Function syntax Classes

The fifth and sixth editions of the ECMAScript specification are most relevant to CoffeeScript. Some of the features introduced by these editions are instantly recognizable from CoffeeScript, others are vaguely familiar, and some are brand new. All of them are explored in this chapter.

JavaScript, ECMAScript? Which is it?

ECMAScript is the name of the language standardized by the ECMA-262 specification by Ecma International. JavaScript is a dialect of ECMAScript (and a trademark of Oracle Corporation), but it’s the name used by almost everybody when referring to the language. In this chapter, ECMAScript is used when referring to the ECMA-262 specification.

13.1.1. A better JavaScript through CoffeeScript

JavaScript is the host for CoffeeScript. The word *host* conjures up images of human parasites like worms and bedbugs. In the case of CoffeeScript, though, JavaScript benefits from the relationship. One of the ways that JavaScript benefits is by taking some of the features in CoffeeScript and adding them to future versions of JavaScript.